

Development of a Digital Twin for Dynamic Simulation and Optimization of Electric Vehicle Charging Demands

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Abstract

As Electric Vehicle (EV) adoption accelerates, optimizing the charging infrastructure is crucial for balancing user satisfaction, energy efficiency, and financial viability. Unlike previous static modeling approaches, this study developed a digital twin based on an agent-based decision-support approach for dynamic simulation and optimization of EV-charging interactions to enable scenario-based analysis. We used a university campus in Hanoi, Vietnam, to evaluate operational policies, EV charging station configurations, and the energy sources for charging electricity. The interactive dashboard enables seasonal analysis, revealing an over 20% drop in solar energy efficiency from October to March and wind power contributing under 5% of demand, underscoring the need for adaptive energy management strategies. The simulation results revealed that notification systems of newly available charging slots significantly boost user satisfaction, while gasoline bans and idle fees improve slot turnover with minimal complexity. Optimization algorithms directly integrate into the system to determine the near-optimal mix of fast (30kW) and standard (11kW) chargers with solar energy, balancing energy efficiency, profitability, and EV demand, while significantly reducing computation time. This digital twin allows optimal development of EV charging stations and will be a powerful tool for EV charging infrastructure.

Keywords: Digital Twins, Agent-Based Modeling, Optimization Algorithms, EVs Charging Infrastructure, Renewable Energy Integration

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1. Introduction

As cities worldwide shift toward sustainable transportation, electric vehicles (EVs) and renewable energy integration have become essential in reducing carbon emissions and promoting environmental sustainability (Al-Thani et al., 2022; Cao et al., 2021). Global EV sales surged by 35% in 2023, reaching 250,000 units weekly, with projections of 17 million by 2024 (IEA, 2024). While the growth is strongest in China, the U.S., and Europe, emerging economies like Vietnam are also experiencing rapid adoption, with EV sales rising from fewer than 100 units in 2021 to a total of over 87,000 by the end of 2024. This rapid transition necessitates a well-planned charging infrastructure (Zhang et al., 2024; Yan and Liu, 2024), yet deployment faces challenges such as rapidly increasing demand, inefficient station layouts, and the need to balance user satisfaction with grid stability (Yu et al., 2021; Hussain et al., 2021). As a solution, hybrid renewable energy systems incorporating solar and wind power can enhance grid performance and expand EV charging capacity (Filote et al., 2020; Sa’adati et al., 2021). However, optimizing these systems requires strategic trade-offs between energy resilience, seasonal variability, and initial investment costs. Additionally, policy interventions, such as smart charging incentives and parking regulations, significantly influence EV adoption, yet comprehensive tools for evaluating these policies remain scarce (Kam et al., 2019). The lack of integrated decision-support tools further limits the ability to optimize station deployment and policy effectiveness (Mouhy-Ud-Din et al., 2024).

Existing studies often rely on static mathematical and optimization models, which oversimplify real-world dynamics and fail to capture the behavioral complexities of EV users and their interactions with infrastructure (Asna et al., 2021; Xiao et al., 2023). While some employ agent-based modelling (ABM) to build dynamic simulations (Cui et al., 2021), they primarily focus on station placement while neglecting key factors such as sizing charging station capacity, evaluating operational policy, and seasonal variations in renewable energy availability. Furthermore, many simulation frameworks lack interactive dashboards, limiting their practicality for policymakers and charging station operators (Zeng et al., 2020). These gaps highlight the need for a comprehensive digital twin with a decision-support ability to assess policies and optimise infrastructure under varying demand scenarios. A

more all-inclusive simulation-based approach, integrating with embedded optimization algorithms, can bridge this gap by providing data-driven insights for EV charging network planning (Mehrerdi and Rakhshani, 2019; Rasca et al., 2024). In light of these challenges, this study investigates the following key questions:

- How can a digital twin with real-time visualization enhance decision-making in EV charging infrastructure planning, particularly for evaluating energy sources?
- How can dynamic simulations efficiently determine the optimal setups of operational policies and station configurations under varying charging demands?
- How can the integration of optimization algorithms into a digital twin minimize computation time while preserving near-optimal solutions for effective EV charging station (EVCS) planning?

Addressing these questions, this paper extends our prior work (Ambrosino et al., 2025) by introducing a more comprehensive digital twin leveraging agent-based modeling for the optimal development of EV charging stations. This tool dynamically simulates EV-charging-energy interactions, offering real-time visualization, scenario-based evaluation, and infrastructure optimization. Acting as a virtual laboratory, it enables stakeholders to test strategies before implementation, bridging the gap between simulation and real-world deployment. While public charging networks are expanding, university campuses are emerging as critical hubs for EV adoption (Caruso et al., 2017; Hovet et al., 2018). This study applies the model to a university campus in Hanoi, Vietnam, named VinUniversity, where rising EV incentives and demand present challenges related to operational and infrastructure constraints. By developing Vietnam’s first digital twin simulation-based EV charging station management model, this study offers a scalable, generalizable decision-support framework to aid policymakers and operating departments in optimizing infrastructure sustainability.

2. Literature review

2.1. Evaluating policy impact on EV Charging Station Operation

Policies play a crucial role in optimizing EVCS utilization and reducing congestion. Heuristic methods, including Genetic Algorithms (GA), Parti-

cle Swarm Optimization (PSO), and Ant Colony Optimization (ACO), have been widely applied to determine optimal infrastructure sizing and operational strategies (Alhasan et al., 2023). System dynamics models offer insights into the long-term relationship between EV adoption and renewable energy incentives (Rasca et al., 2024) but often overlook the short-term operational complexities of charging stations. Agent-based simulations have been used to evaluate policy effectiveness by modelling consumer behavior and competition between charging and fuel stations (Esmaeili et al., 2022). However, most studies rely on predefined policies, lacking flexibility in combining policies or iteratively testing specific strategies. Moreover, there is a lack of decision-support tools capable of assessing how policies, such as smart charging incentives, affect EV user behavior and satisfaction (Kam et al., 2019). This highlights the need for a more flexible and comprehensive framework that integrates policy evaluation with infrastructure optimization, enabling data-driven decision-making in dynamic energy environments.

2.2. EV charging infrastructure capacity optimization

The number of charging ports directly influences station throughput, affecting wait times and user satisfaction. Consequently, numerous studies have identified the capacity sizing of EV charging stations (EVCS) as a critical determinant of operational efficiency. Queuing theory models have been widely applied to optimize the number of charging ports, balancing user convenience with infrastructure costs (Asna et al., 2021; Xiao et al., 2023). Advanced frameworks incorporate both slow and fast-charging station placement to inform investment strategies (Davidov and Pantoš, 2018). Additionally, metaheuristic approaches such as Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO) have been employed to simultaneously optimize station locations and capacities (Liu et al., 2012). Stochastic models assess EV adoption trends and usage patterns, while integrated transportation and power distribution models align charging station deployment with grid constraints (Pagani et al., 2019). To enhance computational efficiency and scalability, advanced algorithms—including PSO and genetic algorithms—have been applied to solve complex location and sizing optimization problems, ensuring cost-effective and efficient EVCS deployment (Xiao et al., 2023; Sun et al., 2022).

Agent-based modelling (ABM) has emerged as a dynamic alternative to static optimization approaches, providing a more detailed representation of user behavior and system interactions. ABMs have been widely used to

simulate EV demand, charging station utilization, and grid interactions under various conditions (Mudiyanse et al., 2024). Several studies have leveraged ABMs to optimize station placement by incorporating forecasted charging demand and vehicle distribution (Cui et al., 2021). However, existing applications primarily focus on station placement rather than optimizing station sizing, evaluating operational policies, or integrating renewable energy sources. As a result, they fail to provide a holistic framework for each individual EVCS planning and management, particularly in the context of large-scale adoption and energy transition.

2.3. Planning renewable energy integration in EV charging stations

Hybrid renewable energy systems—combining solar and wind energy with battery storage—offer a promising approach to reducing grid dependency and enhancing charging station sustainability (Filote et al., 2020). Optimization models suggest that integrating renewable energy into EV charging stations can enhance grid stability and accommodate more EVs (Sa’adati et al., 2021). Several studies have emphasized cost-minimization strategies, including power system reliability checks, renewable energy investment, and leveraging scalable technologies to improve financial feasibility (Davidov and Pantoš, 2018; Li et al., 2022). However, most models assume average solar and wind availability, failing to capture seasonal fluctuations that significantly impact station performance (Rai and Henry, 2016; Holtz et al., 2015).

To address uncertainties in renewable energy supply, various optimization techniques have been applied. Nonlinear stochastic programming models, bilevel programming optimize EV charging behavior to mitigate energy intermittency and minimize costs (Mehrjerdi and Rakhshani, 2019; Zeng et al., 2020). Beyond mathematical optimization, agent-based models are frequently employed to analyze the impact of energy policies and evaluate energy transition scenarios under uncertainty. Simulation tools such as MATLAB Simulink, HOMER, and GAMS are commonly used to optimize the performance of renewable energy-powered EV charging stations (Mehrjerdi and Rakhshani, 2019; Zeng et al., 2020; Diaz et al., 2024). While these tools provide insights into system reliability, energy utilization, and cost-effectiveness, they often lack interactive dashboards, limiting their practicality for real-time decision-making by non-technical stakeholders. The absence of user-friendly visualization tools hinders effective policy evaluation and infrastructure planning, particularly for large-scale renewable integration.

2.4. Research gap and contribution

While significant progress has been made in EVCS optimization, several key gaps remain. Static models oversimplify system dynamics and fail to capture real-time user interactions. Existing simulation-based approaches, particularly ABM, primarily focus on station placement while overlooking sizing, operational policies, and seasonal effects of renewable energy. Additionally, most models lack interactive dashboards, limiting their practicality for decision-makers. Renewable energy integration in EVCS remains under-explored, with many studies neglecting seasonal variations that impact energy availability and system performance. Moreover, although optimization algorithms are widely applied in EVCS planning, they often focus primarily on station placement problems and are typically implemented in isolated analytical platforms. As a result, they fail to provide an integrated and seamless optimization experience within a simulated environment that captures real-world dynamics.

This study addresses these limitations by developing a simulation-based decision-support tool that integrates EV user behavior modelling, policy evaluation, infrastructure optimization, and renewable energy management. The proposed framework leverages ABM to simulate real-world interactions while incorporating an interactive dashboard for scenario-based analysis. Furthermore, by embedding optimization algorithms directly within the digital twin environment, the framework supports seamless decision-making processes, allowing efficient evaluation of planning strategies and dynamic system configurations under varying demand and policy conditions. By bridging the gap between static modeling and real-world implementation, this tool offers a scalable and adaptable solution for optimizing EV charging networks.

3. Methodology

To support EV charging infrastructure planning and policy evaluation, this study develops an agent-based digital twin integrated with optimization and data analytics. Section 3.1 introduces the agent-based modeling framework, describing the design of agents, their interaction logic, as well as the input data and evaluation metrics. Section 3.2 outlines the setup for dynamic simulation experiments, statistical testing and the integration of optimization algorithms into the system.

3.1. Description of the Agent-Based Simulation Model

The agent-based model is implemented using the [GAMA platform](#), an agent-oriented simulation platform inspired by object-oriented programming, particularly Java ([Taillandier et al., 2019](#); [Lesquoy et al., 2024](#)). GAMA was selected for its seamless integration of GIS data as the simulation environment and its ability to create interactive management dashboards with real-time agent movement and dynamic visualizations, including various charts.

3.1.1. Model environment

The model constructs a virtual environment using spatial data from [OpenStreetMap](#) (OSM) and manually sketched buildings from satellite imagery. It primarily covers the VinUni campus ($754\text{m} \times 631\text{m}$) and extends to nearby residential areas ($1174\text{m} \times 1131\text{m}$) for user modeling.



Figure 1: The model environment replicates the campus, manages vehicle flow, parking, and charging, and distinguishes vehicle agents: gasoline (blue circle) & EVs (yellow circles).

Figure 1 illustrates the spatial data used. Key features include residential buildings (cyan) as vehicle home locations, parking areas (dark grey and light

grey), and car-accessible roads (black lines) where interactions with moving agents occur. Other features, such as pedestrian-only paths (gray lines), campus boundaries (beige), and other campus buildings (white), are mainly for visualization. Three gates (diamond shapes) mark the main entry/exit points. OSM data enhances the simulation with geometric attributes like lane count, speed limits, and traffic direction, ensuring a realistic road network model (Minh Duc et al., 2020). By integrating these elements, the model provides a comprehensive and realistic representation of the campus environment.

3.1.2. Model entities

The model consists of three interconnected sub-models: the charging station sub-model, the energy sub-model and the traffic sub-model. These components interact dynamically, reflecting the influence of EV charging behaviors, infrastructure configurations, and renewable energy conditions.

The charging station sub-model represents the campus environment, including buildings, roads, and charging areas. Residential buildings serve as the initialization points for vehicles, and the road network simulates real-world traffic infrastructure. Charging areas replicate the setup of parking area at building C (C-Parking) and building J (J-Parking) (dark grey and light grey rectangles in Figure 1), with variables defining the number and type of charging ports (11kW and 30kW) as shown in Table 1.

Table 1: Variables defining the characteristics of charging areas agent, including the number and type of charging ports available at each location.

Variable Name	Description	Type	Value Range
location_CS	The location of the charging area	string	{"C-Parking", "J-Parking"}
activeCS_11kW	Number of 11kW CPs	integer	[0; 50]
activeCS_30kW	Number of 30kW CPs	integer	[0; 10]
num_CS	Total number of CPs at each building	integer	[0; 100]

The energy sub-model incorporates renewable energy sources into the charging infrastructure, consisting of three agents: BESS (Battery Energy Storage System), solarEnergy, and windEnergy. These agents compute energy production and system costs based on environmental factors such as solar irradiation, air temperature, and wind speed. Table 2 outlines the model’s key attributes, which serve as the primary parameters for energy output calculations, as used in (Brihmat and Mekhtoub, 2014; Sun, 2020).

Table 2: Key attributes of agents in the energy sub-model, detailing parameters for energy output calculations based on renewable energy sources.

Agent Name	Variable Name	Description	Type	Value Range
bess	bess_capacity	BESS storage capacity	float	80000 kW
	bess_SoC	Stored energy in BESS	float	[0, 80000]
solarEnergy	solar_ghi	Solar irradiation	float	[0; 1000]
	air_temp	Air temperature	float	[0; 40]
	nb_solar	Number of PV panels	integer	[0; 1000]
	unit_panel_area	Area of a PV panel	float	2.7 m ²
	total_panel_area	Total PV area	float	[0; 2700]
	current_panel_tmp	Actual PV temperature	float	[0; 40]
	solar_generated	Solar energy generated	float	[0; +∞]
	solar_cost	Total PV system cost	float	[0; +∞]
windEnergy	wind_speed	Actual wind speed	float	[0; 10]
	nb_wind	Number of turbines	integer	[0; 15]
	wind_generated	Wind energy generated	float	[0; +∞]
	wind_cost	Total wind system cost	float	[0; +∞]

The traffic sub-model governs vehicle movements, determining parking and charging slot selection. It includes two types of vehicle agents: gasoline-powered cars and electric vehicles, represented as blue and yellow circles, respectively, in Figure 1. Table 3 shows EV agents’ attributes such as state of charge (SoC), driver satisfaction, charging status, and station preferences (Kam et al., 2019). These agents make charging decisions based on station availability, energy demand, and individual priority, providing a realistic simulation of real-world constraints.

Table 3: Attributes for electric vehicles agent, including state of charge, owner satisfaction, charging status, and station preferences.

Variable Name	Description	Type	Value Range
nb_electrical	Number of EVs per day.	integer	[30; 200]
is_charging	EV is charging or not.	bool	{true, false}
satisfied	EV can access a port when needed.	bool	{true, false}
SoC	Battery level (%) assigned daily.	float	[20; 90]
EV_model	EV models at VinUni.	string	{"VFe34", "VF8", "VF9"}
priority_des	Preference to stay in the current lot.	bool	{true, false}
priority_fast	Preference for fast/slow charging.	bool	{true, false}

This structure allows for an integrated, dynamic representation of campus transportation, energy usage, and charging behaviors.

3.1.3. Model processes

The simulation follows a time-stepped approach, with each step representing a five-minute interval to track vehicle movements and charging behaviors. If the charging infrastructure includes renewable energy, the energy sub-model is executed first to estimate daily energy generation. Then, the traffic and charging station sub-models are updated sequentially.

Weather data, including solar irradiation, air temperature, and wind speed, is retrieved at five-minute intervals at the beginning of each day, specifically for VinUni's parking locations. Solar power generation follows the model from (Brihmat and Mekhtoub, 2014), where the output depends on solar irradiation and temperature, as shown in equation (1). The photovoltaic (PV) power output $P_{PV}(t)$ is calculated by:

$$P_{PV}(t) = k \cdot \frac{G(t)}{G_{ref}} P_{PV,STC} \cdot \eta_{PV} \cdot [1 - \beta_T \cdot (T_c(t) - T_{c,STC})] \quad (1)$$

where:

- $k = 1.15$: Bifacial PV panel absorption efficiency
- $G(t)$: Solar irradiance at time t , $G_{ref} = 800\text{W}$: Reference irradiance
- $P_{PV,STC} = 610\text{W}$: Rated power of PV panel
- $\eta_{PV} = 22.6\%$: Solar absorption efficiency
- $\beta_T = 0.0028$: Temperature-dependent power degradation coefficient.
- $T_{c,STC} = 25$: Panel temperature under standard conditions.
- $T_c(t)$: Panel temperatures computed by air temperature at time t .

Wind power generation $P_W(t)$ follows (Sun, 2020), calculated based on wind speed at the hub height, as shown in equation (2).

$$P_W(t) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } v \leq v_{cut-in} \text{ or } v \geq v_{cut-out} \\ P_{rated} \cdot \frac{v^3(t) - v_{cut-in}^3}{v_r^3 - v_{cut-in}^3}, & \text{if } v_{cut-in} \leq v \leq v_r \\ P_{rated}, & \text{if } v_r \leq v \leq v_{cut-out} \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

where:

- $v(t)$: Actual wind speed at time t , calculated proportionally based on actual wind speed and reference wind speed & turbine height.
- $P_{rated} = 3000W$: Rated power output
- $v_{cut-in} = 3.5$ m/s, $v_{cut-out} = 45$ m/s: Cut-in and cut-out wind speeds
- $v_r = 12$ m/s: Rated wind speed

The simulation is based on dynamic simulation, where agents evolve continuously over time according to predefined rules and events that influence their behavior and state changes. At the start of each cycle, global variables are initialized (Table 4), and agents (e.g., vehicles) are instantiated to represent initial conditions. Each vehicle’s behavior is determined by its state (e.g., parking, working, or leaving), with decision-making processes triggering transitions between states based on predefined conditions.

Table 4: Common state variables for electric and gasoline vehicles, outlining their parking and movement behaviors.

Variable Name	Description	Type	Value Range
parking_area	Targeted parking lot	chargingAreas	{"C-Parking", "J-Parking"}
home	Initial location	residential	one_of(residential_areas)
start_work	Start work time	integer	[8; 9] or [12; 14]
end_work	End work time	integer	[17; 19]
moving_obj	Car’s movement state	string	{"resting", "parking", "working", "leaving"}
parking_slot	Parking slot type	string	{"active-CS", "inactive-CS"}
in_parkingArea	Car in parking area?	bool	{true, false}

Figure 2, adapted and expanded from (Kam et al., 2019; Lee et al., 2020), illustrates the state transition process of the vehicle agent, detailing its decision-making in selecting parking and charging slots. Vehicles begin in a Resting State and proceed to the campus gate at the start time of their work. A key distinction between gasoline vehicles and EVs lies in the "Do Assign Slot" function, which determines parking or charging slots based on the state of charge (SoC) and individual preferences. Vehicles with $SoC \leq 35\%$ prioritize charging while those with SoC between 35% and 70% decide to charge based on a predefined probability. Vehicles with $SoC \geq 70\%$ are considered sufficiently charged and are randomly assigned to inactive charging ports instead. Charging and station preferences (*priority_des* and *priority_fast*) influence slot selection.

The model continuously updates parameters like energy production, SoC of EV and traffic flow. At the end of the day, key performance indicators are aggregated and visualized to evaluate system performance and identify opportunities for optimization.

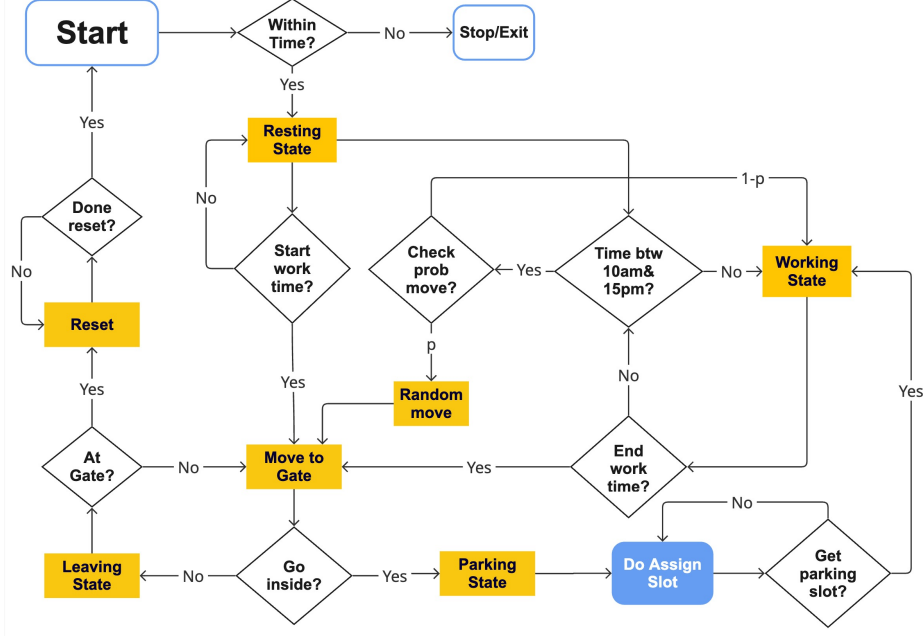


Figure 2: Decision-making process of vehicle agents, expanded from (Kam et al., 2019; Lee et al., 2020). Each timestep follows the same loop for gasoline and EVs, except in "Do Assign Slot," where EV parking depends on SoC and station preferences.

3.1.4. Input Data

A field study analyzed the charging infrastructure and vehicle usage patterns in parking areas. The number of EVs and gasoline vehicles, classified EV types, and recorded parking locations during peak hours (9:00 AM & 2:00 PM) were tracked manually over a week. The university's consistent schedule allowed generalization of vehicle movement patterns. An online survey and qualitative interviews gathered driver behavior insights, covering demographics, parking and charging habits, and system improvement suggestions.

Energy consumption data for EV charging at C-Parking and J-Parking at VinUni's total electricity usage (kWh) in 2023 were provided by the operational team. Historical solar and wind data from Solcast, validated against 48

BSRN ground stations, comprising over 1 million valid hourly average measurements and nearly 3 million instantaneous measurements (Bright, 2019) were used for weather inputs in the simulation, ensuring accurate renewable energy integration.

3.1.5. Evaluation metrics and objective functions

The effectiveness of an EV charging station setup is assessed using three main metrics: user satisfaction, renewable energy efficiency and financial performance.

User satisfaction: This metric represents the percentage of EVs that successfully complete charging, referred to as the satisfaction score. It is analogous to Station Utilization Rates, which assess charging station efficiency based on the number of charging requests served, as discussed in (Yi et al., 2023; Li et al., 2024). A higher satisfaction score indicates greater system efficiency, while lower values may signal issues such as energy shortages, congestion, or insufficient charging infrastructure. The satisfaction score is calculated as:

$$\text{Satisfaction Score} = \frac{\text{EVs that completed charging}}{\text{EVs that requested charging}} \quad (3)$$

Renewable energy efficiency: This evaluates the relationship between energy generation, storage, and consumption, aiming to maximize self-consumption and reduce dependency on external energy (Merei et al., 2016; Francisco et al., 2023; Aldossary et al., 2024). Key ratios include:

$$\text{Self} - \text{Sufficiency} = \frac{\text{Consumed Renewable Energy}}{\text{Total Energy Demand}} \quad (4)$$

$$\text{Self} - \text{Consumption} = \frac{\text{Consumed Renewable Energy}}{\text{Total Generated Renewable Energy}} \quad (5)$$

Financial performance: This is analyzed through cost savings from renewable energy use and the payback period for investments (Merei et al., 2016; Francisco et al., 2023). A shorter payback period indicates greater economic feasibility. The initial renewable energy investment payback is calculated as:

$$\text{Payback Period} = \frac{\text{Investment in Renewable System}}{\text{Monthly Profit}} \quad (6)$$

To ensure comparability, all values are normalized between 0 and 1. The payback period is normalized using the following function to prioritise profit return time within a predefined threshold of the payback period. This approach gives higher priority to payback periods within the acceptable range while reducing the weight of excessively long recovery times.

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{x}{threshold}, & x \leq threshold \\ e^{\frac{threshold-x}{threshold}}, & x > threshold \end{cases} \quad (7)$$

Finally, the optimization metric combines the previous indicators to balance user satisfaction, energy self-sufficiency, and financial viability:

$$\begin{aligned} Objective\ Function = & Satisfaction\ Score + Normalized\ Payback\ Period \\ & + 0.8 \times Self\ Sufficiency \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

This linear function emphasizes maximizing user satisfaction and energy self-sufficiency while ensuring financial feasibility. The weight of 0.8 for self-sufficiency highlights the goal of integrating renewable energy as a supplementary, rather than exclusive, source.

3.2. Experimental and Optimization Setup Description

3.2.1. Dynamic Simulation Experiment Configuration

For Policy Evaluation: The digital twin uses a batch experiment framework to evaluate various policy applications and their impact on user satisfaction. A four-tiered policy framework is tested to improve EV charging station operations:

- Policy 1: Ban gasoline vehicles from charging stations.
- Policy 2: Impose 1,000VND/min idle fee after 30 minutes of full charge.
- Policy 3: Relocate fully charged EVs to inactive stations.
- Policy 4: Real-time notification system of available charging ports.

These policies are introduced incrementally across six scenarios (Table 5), with varying EV numbers (50, 100, 150, 200), a fixed charging station setup including C-Parking (20×11kW, 4×30kW), J-Parking (15×11kW, 4×30kW), and 30 gasoline vehicles across all cases.

Table 5: Scenarios for implementing different operational policy combinations to evaluate their impact on EV charging station operations.

Policy / Case Level	Case 0	Case 1	Case 2	Case 3	Case 4	Case 5
Policy 1: Restrict gasoline vehicles	X	O	O	O	O	O
Policy 2: Impose idle fee	X	X	O	O	O	O
Policy 3: Relocate fully charged EVs	X	X	X	O	X	O
Policy 4: Real-time notification system	X	X	X	X	O	O

For Infrastructure Planning: To determine the optimal configuration for each EV demand scenario, the model simulates all possible parameter combinations across 4 scenarios of EVs number (50, 100, 150, 200). Table 6 outlines the charging station setups and solar panel options, with a fixed BESS and an annual average weather dataset. Due to the expanding number of parameters, C-Parking with solar panels alone has 280 possible configurations, and including J-Parking increases this to 6,720. For simplicity, initial simulations focus on C-Parking, with optimization algorithms extending the analysis to J-Parking.

Table 6: Value ranges for various configurations of charging stations and solar panels, including options for C-Parking and J-Parking.

Category	Configuration Options
C-Parking	11kW Charging Ports: 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50 30kW Charging Ports: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10
J-Parking	11kW Charging Ports: 15, 18, 21, 24, 27, 30 30kW Charging Ports: 2, 4, 6, 8
Solar Panels	200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800, 900
BESS capacity	80kW
Weather Data	Annual average dataset

3.2.2. Statistical Testing for Dynamic Simulation with Wilcoxon Test

The digital twin enables scenario-based simulations, producing time-series results that require statistical validation. Since these simulations often generate limited sample sizes and may involve non-normally distributed data, the Wilcoxon signed-rank test (Wilcoxon, 1945) is an appropriate choice for comparing two paired datasets. Unlike parametric tests such as the paired t-test, which assumes normality, the Wilcoxon test is non-parametric and remains effective in handling skewed data and outliers.

The test evaluates the null hypothesis (H_0) that the median difference between paired observations is zero. It ranks the absolute differences between

paired samples, assigns ranks, and then calculates the test statistic W based on the sum of ranks.

$$W = \min(R^+, R^-) \quad (9)$$

where R^+ and R^- are the sums of positive and negative ranks, respectively. The result is then compared to critical values from the Wilcoxon distribution or assessed using a p-value to determine statistical significance. If $p < 0.05$, there is a statistically significant difference between the two scenarios, providing evidence to reject the null hypothesis H_0 . Otherwise, if $p \geq 0.05$, no clear difference is detected between the two scenarios, meaning there is insufficient evidence to reject H_0 . In this study, we employ the `scipy.stats.wilcoxon` function in Python, which automatically computes the test statistic and corresponding p-value for hypothesis testing.

3.2.3. Optimization Algorithm Integration Settings

The digital twin supports efficient decision-making by integrating various optimization algorithms (described in Table 7), each employing a distinct approach to explore the solution space.

Table 7: Summary of optimization algorithms embedded in the digital twin, describing their approaches and objectives in exploring the solution space.

Algorithm	Source	Description
Hill Climbing	(Pearl, 1984)	A local search that iteratively improves the solution.
Simulated Annealing	(Kirkpatrick et al., 1983)	A probabilistic technique that avoids local optima.
Tabu Search	(Glover, 1989, 1990)	Uses memory structures to avoid revisiting solutions.
Reactive Tabu Search	(Battiti and Tecchioni, 1994)	Adjusts memory size for improved efficiency.
Genetic Algorithm	(Holland, 1975; Goldberg and Holland, 1988)	A population-based algorithm inspired by evolution.
Particle Swarm Optimization	(Kennedy and Eberhart, 1995)	A swarm intelligence method where particles adjust positions based on experience.

These algorithms are assessed based on their accuracy relative to full-case results and runtime, using the Normalized Euclidean Distance (NED) as a comparative metric to quantify deviations from a reference solution, ensuring fair comparison across multiple parameters. Given two solutions $\mathbf{x}_1 = (x_{1,1}, x_{1,2}, \dots, x_{1,n})^\top$ and $\mathbf{x}_2 = (x_{2,1}, x_{2,2}, \dots, x_{2,n})^\top$, NED is computed as equation 10, where s_j represents the feasible range of the j -th variable, ensuring consistency across different scales.

$$D = \sqrt{\sum_{j=1}^n \left(\frac{x_{1,j} - x_{2,j}}{s_j} \right)^2} \quad (10)$$

By applying NED, we obtain a standardized accuracy measure, enabling fair performance assessment across optimization approaches. In this study, NED thresholds are analyzed based on realistic parameter ranges, such as solar panel deployment and charging infrastructure capacity.

4. Results

4.1. Digital Twin enables real-time description and monitoring of EV charging infrastructure

This section describes the real-time interactive dashboard featured in our digital twin, highlighting a use case where the dashboard is utilized to evaluate seasonal solar energy fluctuations.

4.1.1. Dashboard provides real-time map and monitoring charts

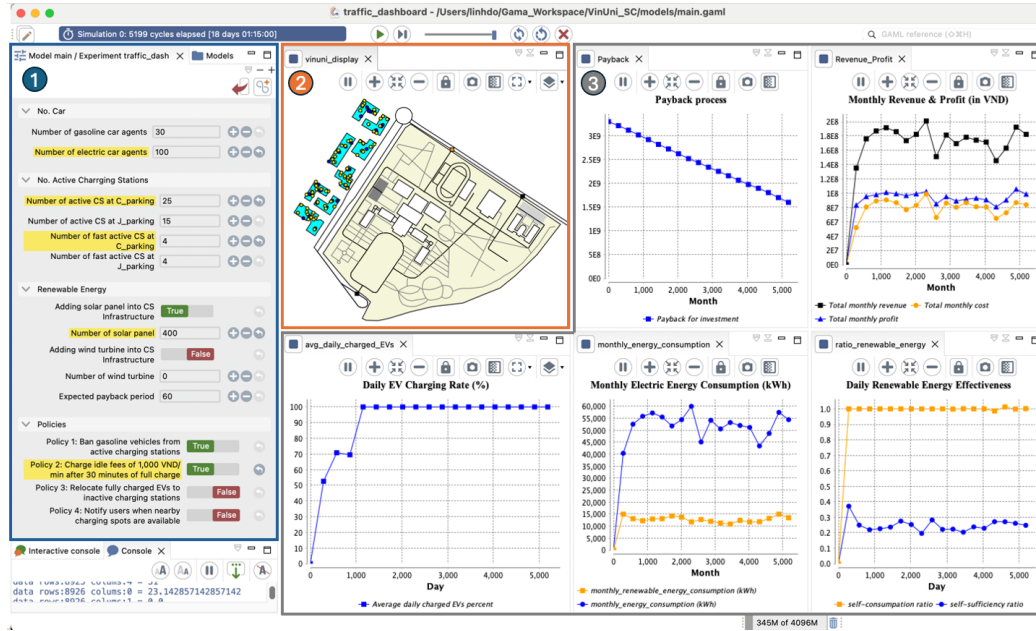


Figure 3: Digital Twin dashboard for real-time EV charging visualization, integrating (1) Interactive parameters control panel, (2) GIS-based interactive multi-agent simulation, and (3) Performance charts tracking user satisfaction, energy efficiency, and financial viability.

Our dashboard, shown in Figure 3, provides a real-time visualization of EV charging operations by integrating an interactive map and monitoring charts that allow users to dynamically explore charging scenarios, adjust station configurations, and evaluate policy impacts. The interface consists of three main components: (1) an interactive control panel (left-hand side) for adjusting station parameters and operational policies, (2) a map-based view (center) displaying the real-time status of charging stations, and (3) a data analytics section presenting key performance indicators (KPIs) such as user satisfaction, energy efficiency, and financial viability.

The system supports scenario-based decision-making, enabling users to simulate the effects of new policies or charging station configurations, observe real-time interactions and calculations, and assess their viability before implementation. This capability significantly enhances decision-making efficiency, allowing operators to proactively manage infrastructure, optimize resource allocation, and improve service reliability. Additionally, the data analytics module helps uncover hidden demand patterns, facilitating strategic planning for future charging infrastructure expansions.

4.1.2. Dashboard reveals seasonal solar fluctuations' impact on energy efficiency and financial viability

To assess the impact of seasonal fluctuations on renewable energy efficiency, a one-month real-time simulation was conducted with 50 EVs and 500 solar panels, keeping other station configurations constant. Four distinct weather datasets, each representing a quarterly average, were used to simulate different seasonal conditions.

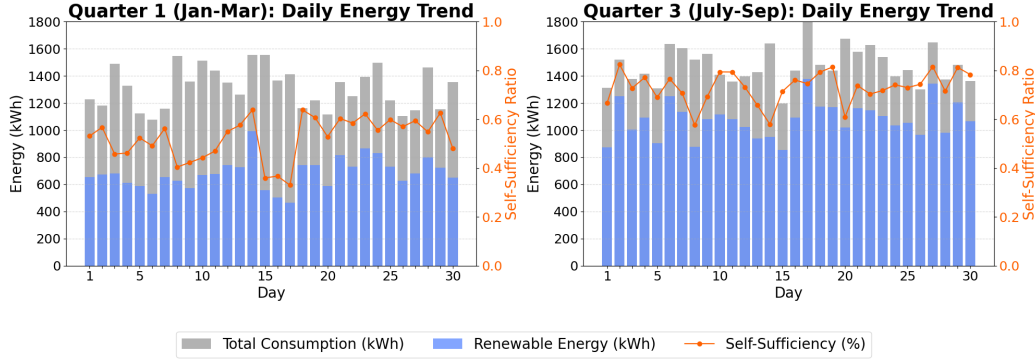


Figure 4: Average one-month simulation results for Quarter 1 & Quarter 3, showing total energy consumption (kWh), renewable energy usage (kWh), and self-sufficiency (%) without wind energy integration.

As shown in Figure 4, results indicate that solar energy output peaks from July to September (Quarter 3), covering 73% of daily electricity demand (1,078 kWh/day). In contrast, from January to March (Quarter 1), solar output declined by 21%, meeting only 52% of demand (681 kWh/day). This seasonal fluctuation significantly affects self-sufficiency and financial returns. During July to September, higher solar generation reduces reliance on grid electricity, leading to a monthly profit of 100 million VND—43% higher than in January to March, when lower solar availability increases grid dependency, limiting profit to 70 million VND despite similar demand conditions.

Wind energy was assessed as a potential complement to solar power during October to March, when solar output was lower. A one-month simulation with 20 wind turbines at 100m height (Figure 5) showed a marginal improvement in self-sufficiency, with the mean self-sufficiency ratio increasing slightly from 0.52 (SD = 0.09) to 0.54 (SD = 0.11). The Wilcoxon test ($p = 0.2801$) confirmed that this difference was statistically insignificant. Consequently, mean daily renewable energy consumption rose only modestly, from 681 kWh to 718 kWh. The limited effectiveness is attributed to peak wind generation occurring outside primary charging hours, specifically from 7:00 PM to 6:00 AM, reducing its direct usability. Despite requiring a 28% increase in initial investment, wind energy contributes under 5% to the total energy supply, but further extending the return-on-investment period.

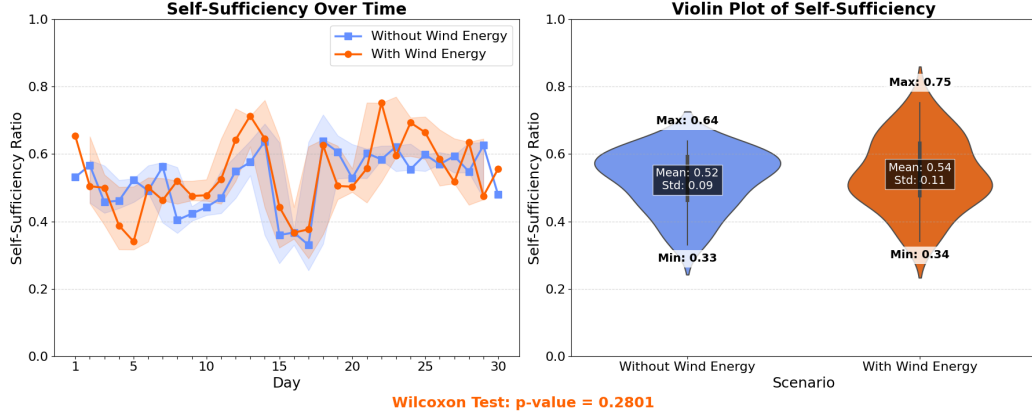


Figure 5: Average one-month simulation results for Q1, comparing self-sufficiency (%) with (orange) and without (blue) wind energy integration using Wilcoxon Test.

To better utilize solar energy, prioritizing BESS expansion over wind investment would be more effective, given the weak wind energy potential in Vietnam. While the simulation includes an 80 kW BESS, further optimization strategies could enhance its efficiency, particularly in scenarios with dynamic electricity pricing and adaptive energy management.

4.2. *Dynamic simulations systematically evaluate operational policies and infrastructure expansion*

Section 4.2 discusses dynamic simulations to explore the effects of operational policies, evaluate charging configurations, and conduct a sensitivity analysis to identify key parameters for optimizing EV charging infrastructure.

4.2.1. *Notification systems improve satisfaction, while idle fees increase slot availability with simple enforcement*

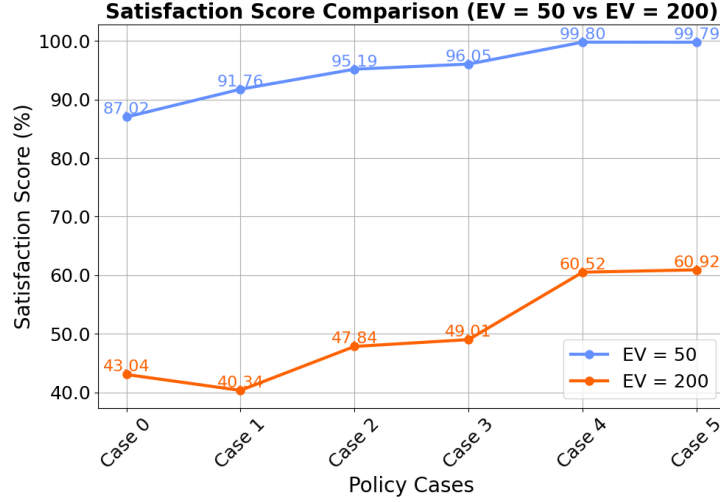


Figure 6: EV satisfaction scores for six combinations of four policy interventions, including gasoline bans, idle fees, EV relocation, and real-time notifications (defined in Table 5).

Simulation results highlight the effectiveness of four key policy interventions, including banning gasoline vehicles, imposing idle fees, relocating fully charged EVs, and implementing a notification system, in improving EV user satisfaction (Figure 6). In the 50-EV scenario, without intervention, gasoline vehicles occupy charging slots, and unregulated EV parking reduces station turnover, keeping satisfaction below 90%. Introducing a gasoline vehicle ban (Case 1) increases station accessibility, while implementing an idle fee (Case 2) further optimizes utilization, raising satisfaction to 95%. However, enforcing EV relocation (Case 3) provides minimal additional benefit (less than 1% increase), indicating that this measure has limited impact. The notification system (Case 4, 5) proves to be the most effective intervention, dynamically informing users of available slots and boosting satisfaction by 5% to nearly 100% in low-demand scenarios (50 EVs). In high-demand cases (200 EVs), the overall trend remains consistent, and the notification system has an even greater effect, increasing satisfaction by over 10% compared to other policies, reaching 60%. However, deploying such a system introduces added complexity and costs, which must be carefully weighed against its benefits.

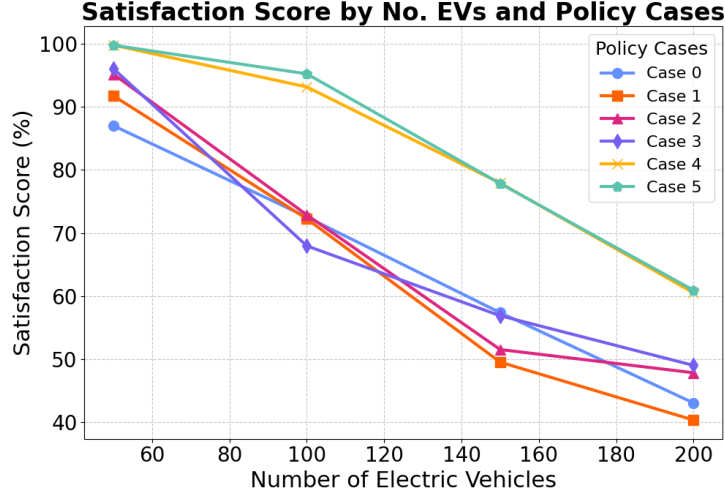


Figure 7: EV satisfaction scores across six policy combination cases (defined in Table 5) as EV size increases from 50 to 200.

Despite these improvements, policies alone cannot fully compensate for infrastructure limitations (Figure 7). Satisfaction drops sharply as EV numbers increase, declining from 87% at 50 EVs to just 43% at 200 EVs, even with multiple policies in place. These findings indicate that while policy interventions enhance station efficiency, they must be complemented by infrastructure expansion to sustain long-term EV adoption. The most effective approach involves banning gasoline vehicles and imposing idle fees to enhance slot turnover, implementing a real-time notification system for slot allocation despite its complexity, and scaling charging infrastructure to accommodate growing demand.

4.2.2. Dynamic simulation identifies optimal configurations for 30kW and 11kW chargers and solar energy

Results from the 280 configuration experiments (Figure 8) reveal distinct performance trends across EV demand levels. For lower demand (50–100 EVs), increasing 11kW chargers steadily improves satisfaction, reaching nearly 100% at 30 chargers (50 EVs) and 50 chargers (100 EVs). However, in higher demand scenarios (150–200 EVs), fast chargers (30kW) become more critical, significantly enhancing satisfaction compared to adding more 11kW units. Satisfaction peaked with 20 (11kW) and 10 (30kW) chargers. Adding more than 40 (11kW) units resulted in diminishing returns, as congestion became

uneven—some chargers were underused while others were overloaded. These findings emphasize the need for a balanced mix of slow and fast chargers to maximize station efficiency.

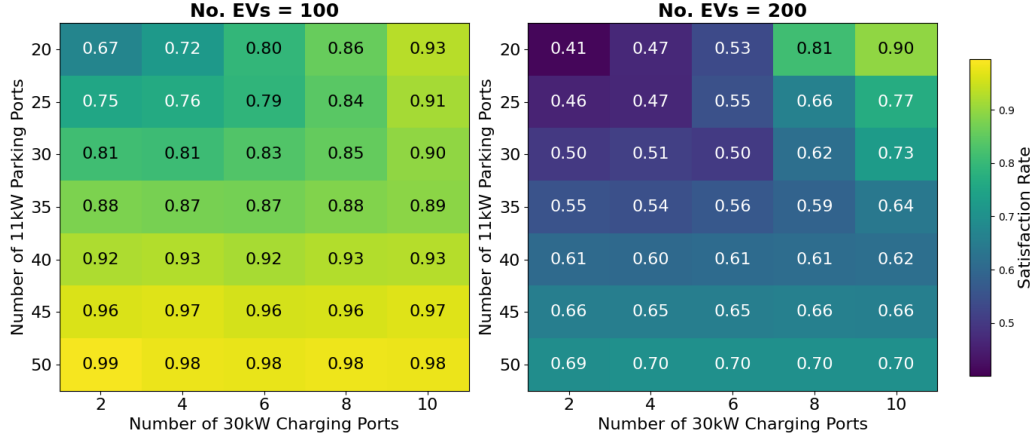


Figure 8: Satisfaction scores for different 30kW (horizontal axis) and 11kW (vertical axis) charger combinations under two demand scenarios: 100 EVs (left) and 200 EVs (right).

Regarding solar panel integration in the 50-EV scenario, Figure 9 shows that self-consumption remains consistently high ($\geq 80\%$), indicating efficient solar energy utilization. However, self-sufficiency starts below 30% but rises to nearly 90% as panel capacity increases. Despite this improvement, economic trade-offs emerge: increasing solar capacity reduces payback efficiency, delaying profitability. With a payback period threshold of 60 months, the results demonstrate that beyond 500 solar panels, additional installations offer negligible financial returns, indicating that oversizing the PV system is not cost-effective. Similar trends are observed across all EV demand scenarios, reinforcing the importance of aligning solar deployment with charging station capacity to optimize investment.

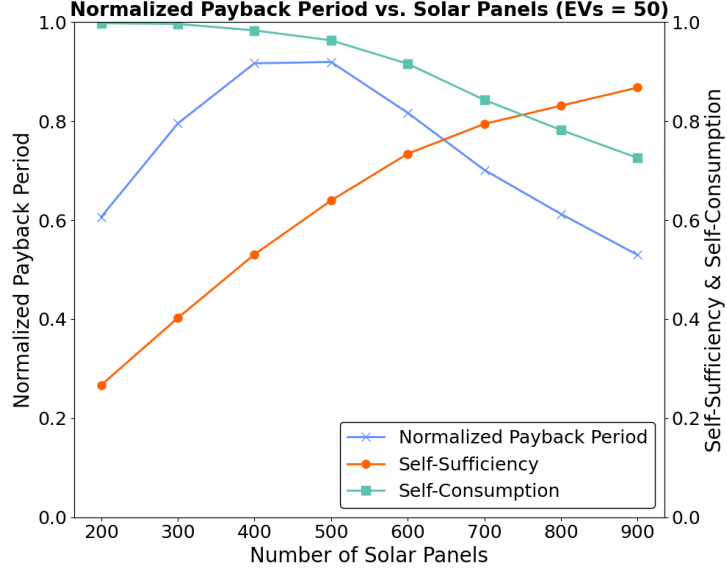


Figure 9: Relationship between number of solar panels and two key metrics: the normalized payback period (blue) and the self-sufficiency and self-consumption (orange and green, respectively) for the 50 EVs scenario.

Table 8: Results from the full case scenario with 280 combinations, detailing the optimal setups for four electric vehicle demand scenarios (50, 100, 150, 200 EVs).

Note: CS = Charging Station; CPs = Charging Ports.

	50 EVs	100 EVs	150 EVs	200 EVs
CS Configuration				
No. CPs 11kW	35	50	20	20
No. CPs 30kW	4	4	10	10
No. Solar Panels	500	900	600	600
Evaluation Metrics				
Satisfaction Score	1.00	0.99	0.94	0.89
Self-Consumption	0.99	0.98	0.95	0.93
Self-Sufficiency	0.67	0.60	0.59	0.57
Normalized Payback	0.94	0.98	0.95	0.92
Objective Function	2.47	2.45	2.37	2.26

The optimal configurations derived from the Objective Function evaluation (Table 8) balance these trade-offs, ensuring high satisfaction, cost efficiency, and energy performance. The results underscore the importance of a well-balanced mix of 30kW and 11kW chargers, along with an optimally sized solar array, to maximize station efficiency and economic sustainability.

4.2.3. Sensitivity analysis highlights 30kW chargers and notifications boost satisfaction, while solar panels drive self-sufficiency and payback

Sensitivity analysis identifies the most influential factors affecting EV satisfaction, station efficiency, and financial viability. As shown in Figure 10, results indicate that fast charger availability (30kW) and the implementation of a notification system are the two most critical variables impacting satisfaction scores. The Total-Order Sobol Indices reveal that EV satisfaction is primarily influenced by the number of 11kW (ST = 0.38) and 30kW chargers (ST = 0.34), with only a minor difference of 0.04. Despite their smaller range and step size (2–10 with step 2 vs. 20–50 with step 5 for 11kW chargers), 30kW chargers demonstrate a comparable impact, reinforcing their efficiency in high-demand scenarios. Among policy interventions, the notification system (ST = 0.37) has the most substantial effect, dynamically improving slot allocation and reducing waiting times.

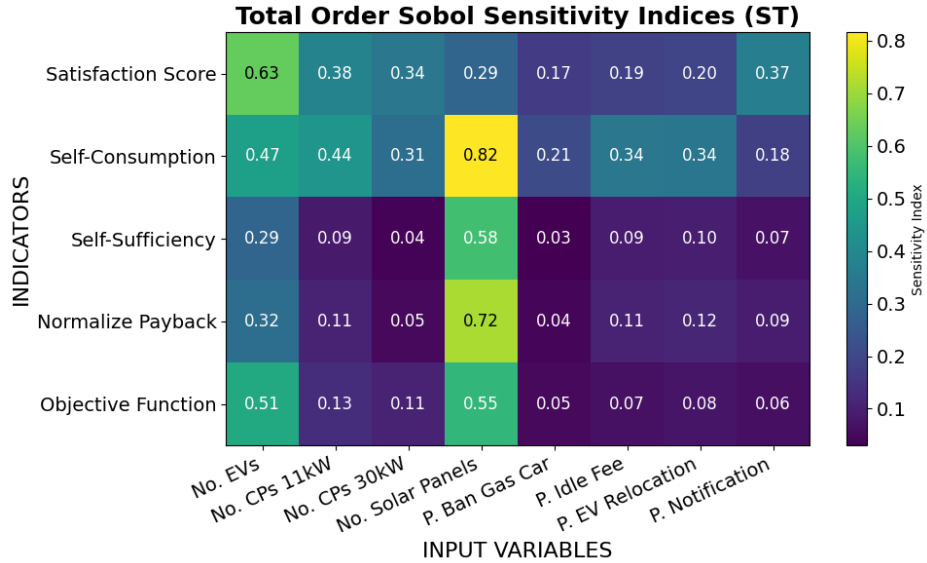


Figure 10: Heatmap of the Total-Order Sobol Sensitivity Indices (ST) of key factors affecting EV satisfaction, station efficiency, and financial viability.

For energy performance, solar panel capacity has the strongest influence on self-sufficiency and payback period. Additionally, idle fees and relocation policies (both ST = 0.34) significantly enhance self-consumption by optimizing station utilization and aligning charging demand with solar availability.

However, since their effects are nearly identical, forced relocation may offer little added value over idle fees, questioning its necessity given the additional enforcement effort required.

These results align and reinforce the conclusions from Sections 4.2, emphasizing the critical role of fast chargers, notification systems, and optimal solar panel sizing in improving EV charging efficiency and financial sustainability.

4.3. *Embedded optimization algorithms in digital twin enable efficient decision-making*

Our Digital Twin tool provides a comprehensive optimization environment, enabling both exhaustive batch experiments for small-scale scenarios and embedded optimization algorithms for efficiently finding near-optimal solutions in complex, high-dimensional cases. By integrating optimization directly into the Digital Twin framework, our tool significantly reduces computational time while maintaining solution quality.

As shown in Section 4.2.2, exhaustive batch simulations allow for evaluating all possible configurations, providing key insights into optimal infrastructure setups, variable impacts, and system patterns. However, as the number of parameters increases, the computational burden grows exponentially, making exhaustive testing impractical. To address this, our tool directly embeds optimization algorithms within the simulation environment, unlike other studies that require external execution. Six widely used algorithms—hill climbing, simulated annealing, tabu search, reactive tabu search, genetic algorithm, and particle swarm optimization (PSO)—have been integrated to efficiently explore the solution space and identify near-optimal configurations for large-scale decision-making.

The optimization algorithms generate solutions closely aligned with full-case results, with minor deviations (at most one adjustment step): at most ± 5 charging ports (11kW), ± 2 charging ports (30kW), and ± 100 solar panels. To illustrate the efficiency gains, we analyze a representative optimization run using PSO, as shown in Figure 11 and Table 9. The Normalized Euclidean Distance values (ranging from 0.656 to 1.345) indicate minimal deviation between PSO and full-case solutions. For EV50 and EV200, distances of 1 and 0.656 show near-identical results. Slightly higher values for EV100 and EV150 (1.238 and 1.345) stem from the relative influence of solar panel quantities in the optimization process, as they contribute more

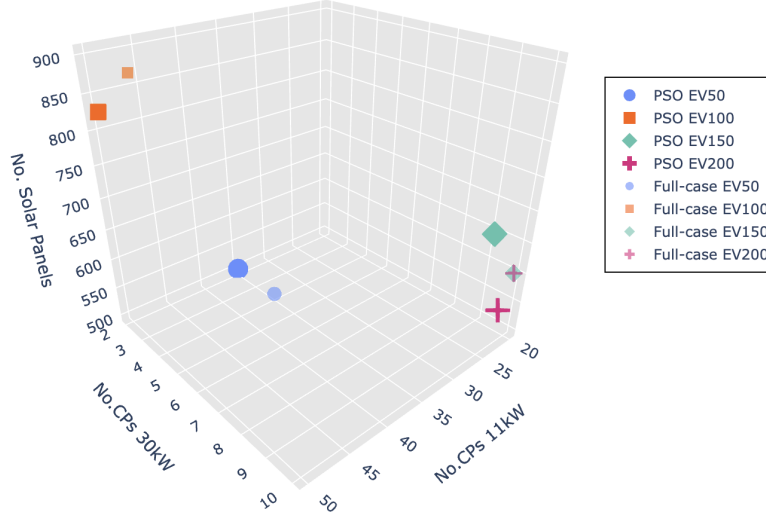


Figure 11: Comparison of PSO optimization vs. full-case results across solar panels and charging port configurations (11 kW & 30 kW). Each point represents configurations for 50 EVs, 100 EVs, 150 EVs, and 200 EVs, with PSO results shown as bigger markers.

significantly to overall system performance compared to charging port variations. Since the full-case method only considers predefined discrete values, while PSO can optimize outside these constraints, some deviation is expected. However, the results confirm that PSO delivers near-optimal solutions while reducing computational time by 82%, as PSO only needs to evaluate around 50 configurations compared to the 280 combinations required in the full-case scenario.

Table 9: Results comparison of PSO with full-case, highlighting configurations for different EV cases and their normalized Euclidean distances.

EV Case	No. 11kW, No. 30kW, No. Solar		Norm. Euclidean Distance
	PSO	Full-case	
EV50	(35, 2, 500)	(35, 4, 500)	1.000
EV100	(50, 2, 827)	(50, 4, 900)	1.238
EV150	(25, 10, 690)	(20, 10, 600)	1.345
EV200	(22, 10, 548)	(20, 10, 600)	0.656

Finally, applying PSO to optimize charging configurations for both C-Parking and J-Parking, which involve 6,720 combinations—24 times more

than cases without J-Parking variations—yields results after evaluating only about 50 configurations, as shown in Table 10. This optimization determines the optimal allocation of charging ports (11kW & 30kW) and solar panels for both locations.

Table 10: Optimal setups determined by PSO for both C-Parking and J-Parking, showcasing the configurations for four EV demand scenarios (50, 100, 150, 200 EVs). *Note:* CS = Charging Station; CPs = Charging Ports; C = C-Parking; J = J-Parking.

	50 EVs	100 EVs	150 EVs	200 EVs
CS Configuration				
No. CPs 11kW (C)	32	50	20	20
No. CPs 30kW (C)	3	3	10	10
No. CPs 11kW (J)	15	15	15	15
No. CPs 30kW (J)	2	8	8	8
No. Solar Panels	604	900	543	600
Evaluation Metrics				
Satisfaction Score	1.00	0.97	0.93	0.95
Self-Sufficiency	0.75	0.61	0.56	0.57
Normalized Payback	0.86	0.97	0.90	0.93
Objective Function	2.46	2.43	2.28	2.34
No. Cases Tested	52	54	51	53

5. Discussion

This study presents a Digital Twin framework that integrates real-time visualization, simulation, and optimization to enable data-driven decision-making for EV charging infrastructure. Implemented on a university campus in Hanoi, the framework facilitates scenario-based evaluations of policies, infrastructure configurations, and renewable energy integration, providing valuable insights for managing a sustainable EV network.

The interactive dashboard meets the need for decision-making tools identified in prior research (Mouhy-Ud-Din et al., 2024; Zeng et al., 2020) by offering real-time visualizations, performance tracking, and scenario simulations. In contrast to earlier models that oversimplify real-world dynamics (Asna et al., 2021; Xiao et al., 2023), our digital twin allows for seasonal analysis, revealing a 21% decrease in solar efficiency from October to March and a minimal contribution of wind power ($\leq 5\%$ of demand), despite a 28% increase in investment. While previous studies (Filote et al., 2020) suggest that hybrid solar-wind systems enhance grid performance, our findings

indicate that in low-wind regions such as Hanoi, peak wind generation occurs outside of charging hours (7:00 PM–6:00 AM), limiting its effectiveness. This highlights the importance of optimizing BESS capacity and employing demand-response strategies to address intermittency and maximize renewable energy utilization. Currently, our research utilizes a fixed BESS, which has not yet been fully developed as an agent with complex behaviors within our digital twin framework. Future research could expand on this by exploring dynamic pricing scenarios, such as peak-hour pricing, where optimizing BESS operations becomes crucial for enhancing the system’s ability to integrate solar energy effectively.

The Digital Twin framework proposed in this paper provides a scalable and adaptable solution, enabling stakeholders to simulate, evaluate, and optimize charging configurations before real-world deployment, ensuring efficient, cost-effective, and sustainable EV charging networks. Our simulation evaluates the impact of policies, showing that notification systems increase satisfaction by 10% during high-demand periods, while gasoline bans and idle fees improve slot turnover. For long-term planning, policy interventions alone cannot resolve infrastructure limitations, underscoring the need for expanded charging capacity. The simulation allows for testing various configurations, while the embedded optimization framework reduces computational overhead, ensuring near-optimal configurations of fast (30kW) and standard (11kW) chargers with solar energy. While previous studies (Sun, 2020; Liu et al., 2012) place optimization outside the simulation environment, our approach integrates it directly within the Digital Twin, enabling real-time adaptability and reducing computational time by over 80%. However, the model has limitations, particularly regarding dataset assumptions based on our small-scale survey. For example, it assumes ideal user compliance with operational policies, though real-world behavior in larger environments is influenced by more complex factors. Expanding the Digital Twin to citywide applications could provide valuable insights into large-scale EV infrastructure planning, further advancing smart and sustainable transportation systems.

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